PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Pour into the students, one build at a time.

Microsoft already invests in young Jamaicans who want to build with technology. Hack876 is one day where high-school students get to do exactly that, with Microsoft people in the room.

WHAT HACK876 IS

A one-day build competition in Kingston for about 80 secondary-school students, 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4. Teams pick a real problem and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges.

When: Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative)

Where: Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston (confirmed)

Who: About 80 students, roughly 20 teams

Organisers: Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers



WHY MICROSOFT

Microsoft already invests in young Jamaican builders through Project Blue Mountain, and a Hack876 judge works at Microsoft.

WHAT WE ARE ASKING

Three to five Microsoft mentors for AI, cloud and data on the day, in person or remote.

WHAT IT MAKES POSSIBLE

Teams building with AI and data get help from people who do it professionally, and a short AI fundamentals session beforehand if Microsoft can offer one.

WHAT MICROSOFT RECEIVES

In-kind recognition, a written recap, and Microsoft staff working directly with about 80 students a few years before university.

THE NEXT STEP

A reply on whether mentors are possible, and who inside Microsoft would need to approve it.

Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · info@hack876.com

01 THE REQUEST

What we are asking for, and how it would be used.

Jordan Howell, Hack876 judge · Microsoft. Jordan is a confirmed Hack876 judge who works at Microsoft.

Mentors are the request. Microsoft already funds student hackathon prizes in Jamaica, so a contribution toward the Hack876 prizes is a natural alternative.

- ✓ **Microsoft mentors for AI, cloud and data, in person or remote**
- ✓ **A short pre-event AI fundamentals session for teams**
- ✓ **Cloud credits held by organisers to host team demos, with no student accounts required**
- ✓ **A speaker from Microsoft in Jamaica**

QUANTITIES, TIMING AND DELIVERY

Mentors: any part of the build period on the day, at Spanish Court Hotel or by video.

Optional: a short AI fundamentals session for teams before the day.

No student accounts are required. Any cloud credits would be held by organisers.

A contribution toward the prizes is welcome as an alternative or an addition.

WHY MICROSOFT

Microsoft piloted Project Blue Mountain in 2024 to help make Jamaica the premier hub for STEAM talent development in the Caribbean, reaching secondary and tertiary institutions.[3]

Shane Patterson on leading it: "Coming back home and being able to pour into the students the way I would've wanted for myself is priceless."[4]

Tech Wave 2025 was set to open to high-school students for the first time, alongside university teams, with more than 30 teams mentored by technical experts.[4]

WHAT MICROSOFT WOULD RECEIVE

In-kind Partner · Inaugural Hack876

A meaningful in-kind contribution can be recognized at an equivalent level, based on a usable value agreed together. The advertised value of software credits or volunteer hours is not counted as cash automatically.

A monetary contribution is welcome instead. The levels are on the last page.

02 DELIVERY AND NEXT DECISION

Who is running it, and what we need from you.

ORGANISERS	Nadani Dixon (Redfin) and Stefen Ewers (Anthropic Claude Ambassador) lead the event and are the contacts for this proposal.
VENUE	Spanish Court Hotel in Kingston is confirmed as the venue.
DATE	Saturday, February 20, 2027 is the working date. It is tentative until confirmed with schools.
JUDGES	7 judges have confirmed, from Tesla, Microsoft, Meta, Google, Accenture, Diageo, HashiCorp.

Schools: 1 confirmed, 2 in talks, 6 not yet confirmed, from a network of 9 in Kingston. Sponsors do not receive student contact details, and there are no sign-ups or selling on the day. Photos and names are used only with school and parent consent.

Our judge Jordan Howell, who works at Microsoft, is a Campion College alumnus. Status with Hack876: confirmed.

THE DECISION WE ARE ASKING FOR

A reply on whether mentors are possible, and who inside Microsoft would need to approve it.

Your contact: Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · info@hack876.com

WHAT YOU WOULD RECEIVE AFTERWARDS: A WRITTEN RECAP

- ✓ **How many students, teams and schools took part**
- ✓ **What the teams built, with the finalist projects described**
- ✓ **How your contribution was used**
- ✓ **Photos, only where schools and parents have consented**

We do not report reach, impressions or leads, and we do not share student contact details.

If a monetary contribution suits better: the levels.

Bronze Partner

J$50,000 to below J$200,000

- Recognition on the Hack876 website
- Included in the grouped sponsor thank-you
- Named in the post-event recap

Silver Partner

J$200,000 to below J$500,000

- Everything in Bronze
- Placement on event signage
- Acknowledgement in the opening and closing

Gold Partner

J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000

OUR SUGGESTION

- Everything in Silver
- More prominent placement
- A dedicated sponsor feature
- Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced*

Platinum Partner

J$1,000,000+

- The most prominent sponsor placement
- An agreed opportunity to take part in the programme
- Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced*

These are proposed benefits, to be agreed when a sponsorship is confirmed. A sponsor can contribute any amount within a band.

*Shirt placement applies only if event shirts are produced and artwork arrives before the production deadline.

Speaking, mentoring, presenting an award and judging are subject to suitability and programme capacity. Sponsorship does not buy influence over judging, and no level carries naming rights.

In-kind & Community Support: For contributions in kind, and for contributions below J$50,000. A meaningful in-kind contribution can be recognized at an equivalent level, based on a usable value agreed together. The advertised value of software credits or volunteer hours is not counted as cash automatically.

SOURCES

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2. Microsoft, "About Microsoft (mission)." www.microsoft.com/en-us/about

3. Canada Caribbean Institute, "NCU students showcase waste management app (October 27, 2024)." canadacaribbeaninstitute.org/2024/10/27/ncu-students-showcase-waste-management-app/

4. Jamaica Observer, "Project Blue Mountain's Tech Wave Conference set to stir talent, drive innovation (October 22, 2025)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2025/10/22/project-blue-mountains-tech-wave-conference-set-stir-talent-drive-innovation/

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6. Microsoft On the Issues, "Microsoft Elevate: Putting people first, Brad Smith (July 9, 2025)." blogs.microsoft.com/on-the-issues/2025/07/09/elevate/

7. Jamaica Gleaner, "UTech to host Microsoft Day 2024 (October 1, 2024)." past.jamaica-gleaner.com/article/news/20241001/utech-host-microsoft-day-2024

8. Jamaica Observer, "AIM Educational Services and Microsoft empower youth with AI bootcamp (July 24, 2025)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2025/07/24/aim-educational-services-microsoft-empower-youth-ai-bootcamp/

A private partnership proposal prepared for Shane Patterson, Principal Technical Program Manager, Microsoft, and Executive Director, Project Blue Mountain, with Yamile Bustamante, Country Representative, Microsoft Jamaica.